

Post-Operative Instructions: Frenectomy

It Is Essential That You

- Maintain continuous firm pressure on gauze pads directly over surgical site for 30 minutes.
- Rest at home today and keep talking to a minimum.
- Wear your cold packs for the rest of today even if you have no or minimal swelling.
- Do not spit, suck on straws or brush teeth today.
- Do not smoke for at least 3 days.
- Take medication for discomfort before numbing wears off.

Bleeding

Most of your bleeding will have subsided by the time you leave our office. Continued oozing for 24 hours after surgery is quite normal. Once home, if still bleeding, change the gauze pack for a fresh one, relax, elevate your head for 30 minutes. Typically 2 to 3 changes is all that is required. Do not use gauze packs if bleeding is only minimal or slight.

Mouth Rinses

Beginning tomorrow, rinse mouth every 4 to 6 hours with warm, slightly salty water (1/2 teaspoon in a tall glass of water) for the following week. Begin brushing your teeth the day after surgery, avoiding any areas with stitches.

Swelling and Bruising

Swelling and bruising often occurs after surgery and are completely normal. Swelling typically increases for the first 3 to 4 days, then gradually subsides over the following 3 to 7 days. Applying cold or ice packs the entire day of your surgery is very helpful to minimize the amount of swelling you will experience. Wear them even if you feel there is little initial swelling. Keep the cold packs against your lip for 30 minutes, then re-apply.

Discomfort

Following oral surgery you can expect some degree of discomfort. This typically lasts 2 to 6 days and is much like a "crampy tenderness". The degree varies, depending upon the difficulty or extent of surgery. In general, the younger the patient, the less discomfort and shorter the healing period.

Medications

Take the medications as directed on the bottle. The medication prescribed should keep you relatively comfortable and is best taken with fluid or food in your stomach. For mild discomfort Tylenol or Advil (ibuprofen) may be used. Some pain medications can cause dizziness; do not drive.

Diet

Most people can begin drinking fluids once home. Start with clear fluids initially and progress to soup (such as chicken or beef broth), fruit or vegetable juice. The evening of surgery is fine to start milk products such as

milkshakes, yogurt, and pudding. Drink as much as you are able. Small amounts should be taken frequently. Advance your diet over the next few days to include softer items such as pasta, scrambled eggs, well cooked vegetables, fish, and similar foods. Avoid straws for the first few days as the suction can cause bleeding. Avoid acidic and spicy foods which could cause discomfort in the wound.

When to Call Us | (proposed, needs Dr. Luong's approval)

Call the office right away if you have any of these:

- Heavy or increased bleeding, or bleeding that does not subside
- Pain or swelling that increases or continues beyond three days
- Bad taste or odor in your mouth
- A reaction to your medication
- Fever
- **Difficulty breathing**

Call (225) 925-2118. For emergencies, call 911 or contact your emergency department.

Questions or concerns, call (225) 925-2118. After hours or on weekends, leave a message and someone will return your call shortly. For a medical emergency, including difficulty breathing, call 911 or go to your nearest emergency department.

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